ClaudeClaw

SETUP GUIDE

Your personal AI assistant, running on your computer, controlled from your phone.

WHAT YOU'LL SET UP

- Homebrew
- Node.js
- Claude Code
- Telegram Bot

Starting from a brand new Mac with nothing installed.
Total time: ~30 minutes

Your Setup Sidekick

Before you start, open claude.ai (or the Claude desktop app) in a separate window. This is your troubleshooting buddy. If you hit a wall at any point, paste the error into that window and it'll tell you exactly what to do.

Upload this entire guide as a file into a new Claude conversation, then paste this prompt:

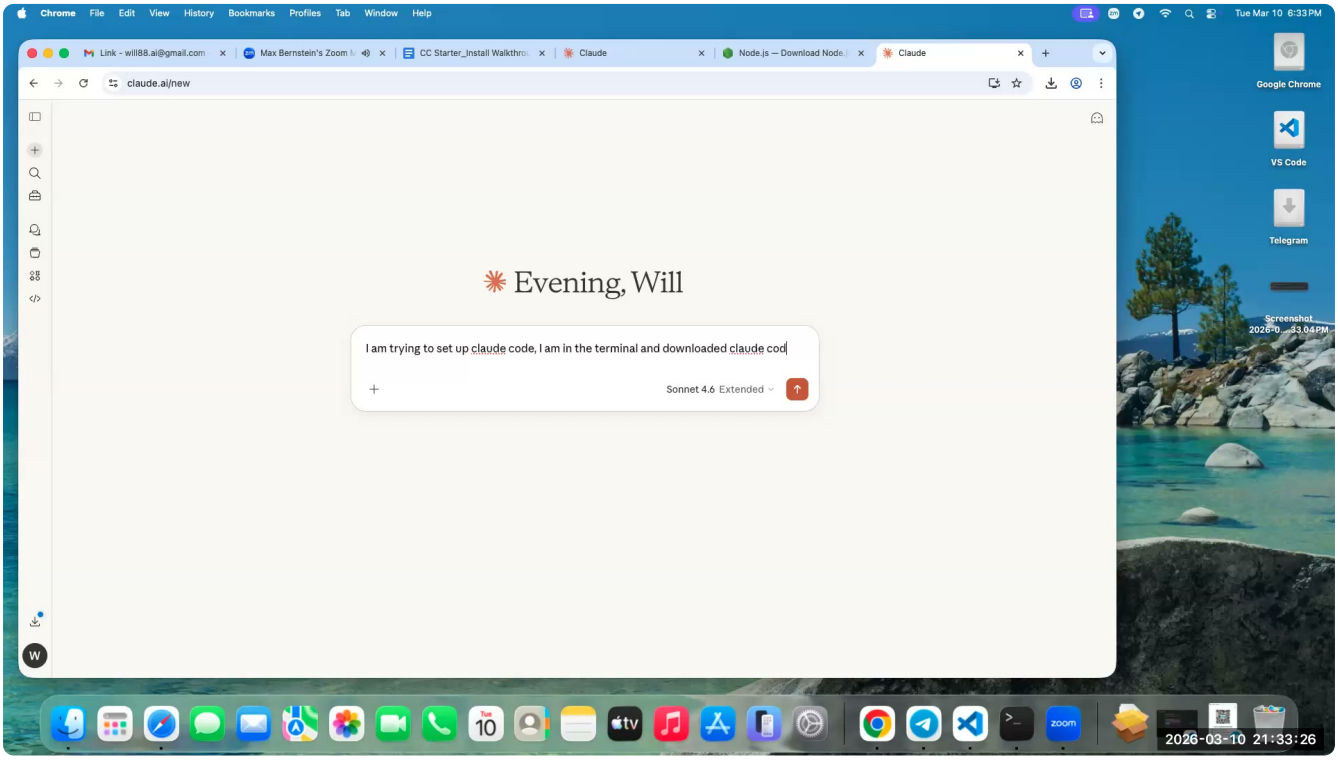
```
I just uploaded the setup guide I'm following. I'm installing
ClaudeClaw on my [Mac Mini / MacBook / iMac] running macOS
[version -- check Apple menu > About This Mac].

You are my setup sidekick. Here's how to help me:

- When I paste an error from Terminal, tell me the exact
 command to fix it. No explaining, just the fix.
- When I send a screenshot, tell me what I'm looking at
 and what to click or type next.
- If you need more info, ask ONE specific question.
- Reference the step number from the guide.

I'm starting now.
```

Keep that window open the whole time. Every error, every weird screen, just paste it in.



Real example: Will opened claude.ai as his troubleshooting buddy during setup

What You're Installing (and why)

Tool	What it is	Why you need it
Homebrew	Mac's app store for dev tools	Installs everything else cleanly
Node.js	Runs JavaScript on your computer	ClaudeClaw is a Node app
Git	Downloads code from GitHub	Gets ClaudeClaw's source code
Claude Code	Anthropic's CLI for Claude	The brain of your bot
VS Code	Code editor (optional)	Easiest way to manage things
Telegram	Messaging app	Your remote control

PHASE 0

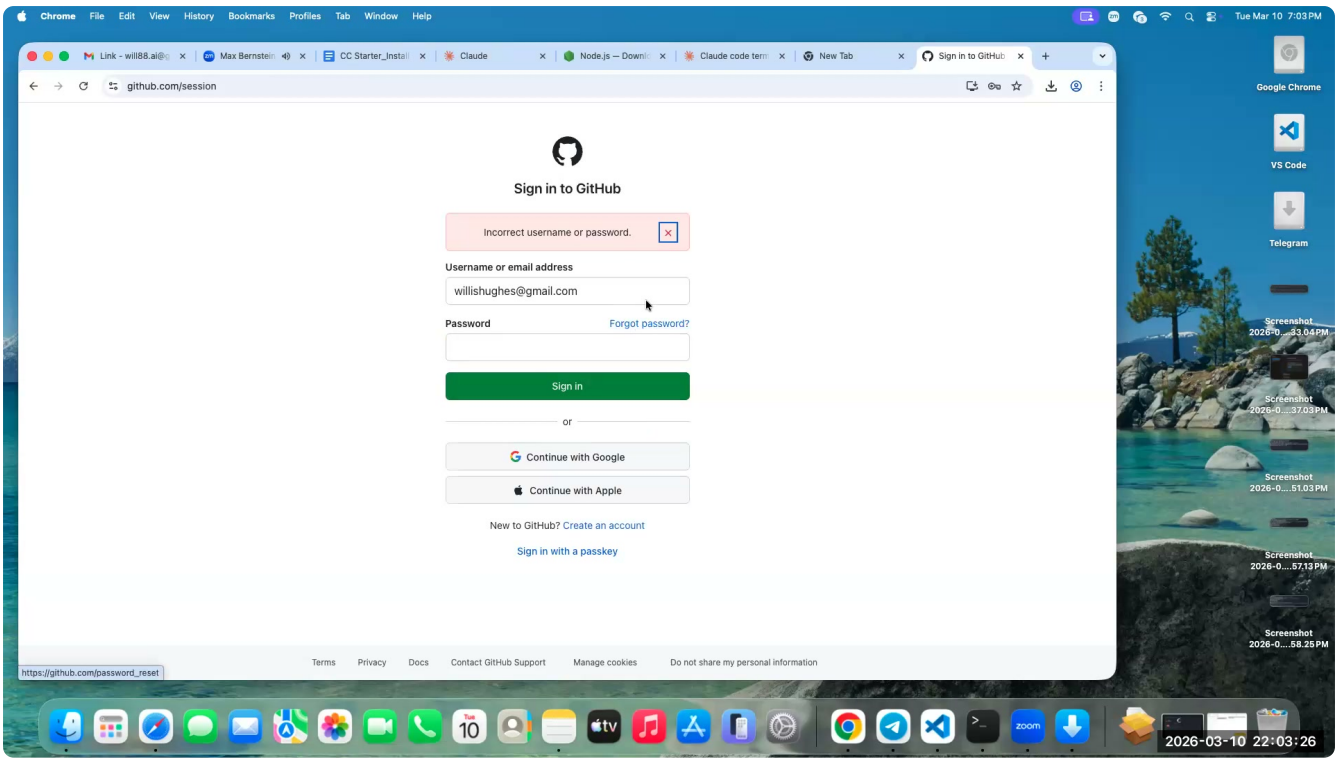
Accounts to Create First

5 minutes -- do this before touching your Mac

Open these in browser tabs and create accounts. Do it from your phone or another computer.

- [ ] Anthropic -- go to claude.ai, create an account (Pro or Max subscription, $20-100/mo)
- [ ] GitHub -- go to github.com, create a free account (tip: use "Continue with Google" to skip the password hassle)
- [ ] Telegram -- install the app on your phone, create account with your phone number
- [ ] Groq -- go to console.groq.com, free account, go to API Keys, create one. Save it. (For voice notes, totally free.)

Write down your GitHub username. You'll need it.



GitHub sign-in -- note the 'Continue with Google' option to skip password creation

PHASE 1

Mac Setup

10 minutes

Open Terminal

Press Command + Space, type Terminal, hit Enter. You'll see a window with text like "macmini ~ %" and a blinking cursor.

Terminal tips for non-terminal people

- Paste is Command+V (same as everywhere else)
- You won't see passwords as you type them. The cursor won't move. This is normal.
- If something looks stuck, try pressing Enter
- If something is REALLY stuck, press Control+C to cancel
- If you end up in a screen that won't let you type (called "vim"), type :q! and press Enter

Step 1: Install Homebrew

Paste this entire line into Terminal and press Enter:

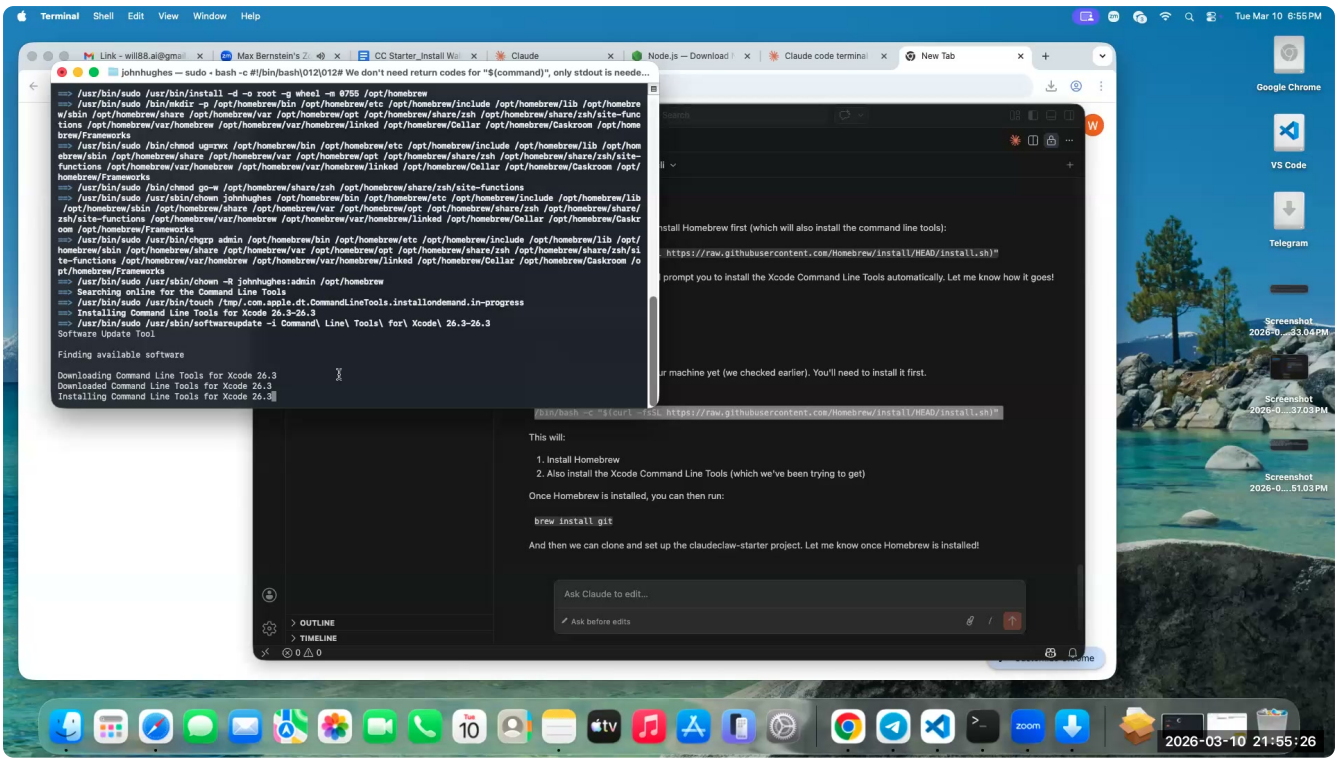
```
/bin/bash -c "$(curl -fsSL
https://raw.githubusercontent.com/Homebrew/install/HEAD/install.sh)"
```

It asks for your Mac password (the one you use to log into the computer). Type it and press Enter. You won't see characters appear. That's normal.

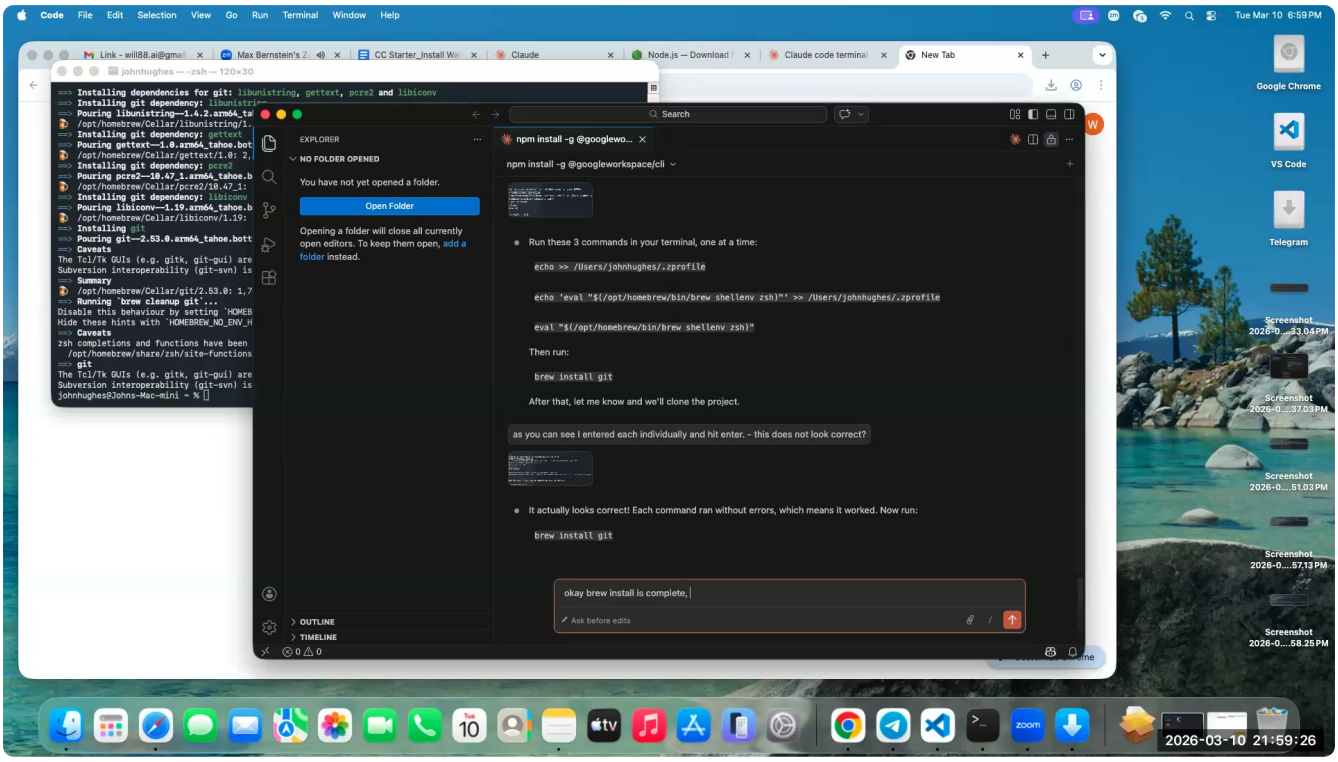
This takes 2-5 minutes. It also installs Xcode Command Line Tools automatically.

Important: Run the PATH commands

When Homebrew finishes, it shows "Next steps" with 3 commands to run. You MUST copy and run each one. If you skip this, every brew command will fail with "command not found."



Homebrew installing in Terminal -- watch for the 'Next steps' output at the end



The sidekick helped Will find and run the PATH commands when he got stuck

Verify it worked:

```
brew --version
```

Should show "Homebrew 4.x.x". If "command not found", close Terminal (Command+Q) and reopen.

Step 2: Install Node.js and Git

```
brew install node git
```

Verify both:

```
node --version && git --version
```

Should show two version numbers like v22.14.0 and git version 2.47.1

Step 3: Set up Git identity

Use your real name and the email connected to your GitHub account:

```
git config --global user.name "Your Name"
git config --global user.email "your@email.com"
```

No output means it worked.

Step 4: Prevent the Vim Trap

Some tools open a text editor called Vim, which is famously impossible to exit. This prevents it:

```
echo 'export EDITOR=nano' >> ~/.zshrc && source ~/.zshrc
```

PHASE 2

Install Claude Code

5 minutes

Step 1: Install

```
npm install -g @anthropic-ai/claude-code
```

Wait ~30 seconds.

> **Permission error?**
>
> If you get EACCES or "operation not permitted", run:
> sudo npm install -g @anthropic-ai/claude-code
> It asks for your Mac password again.

Step 2: Fix the PATH (if needed)

```
claude --version
```

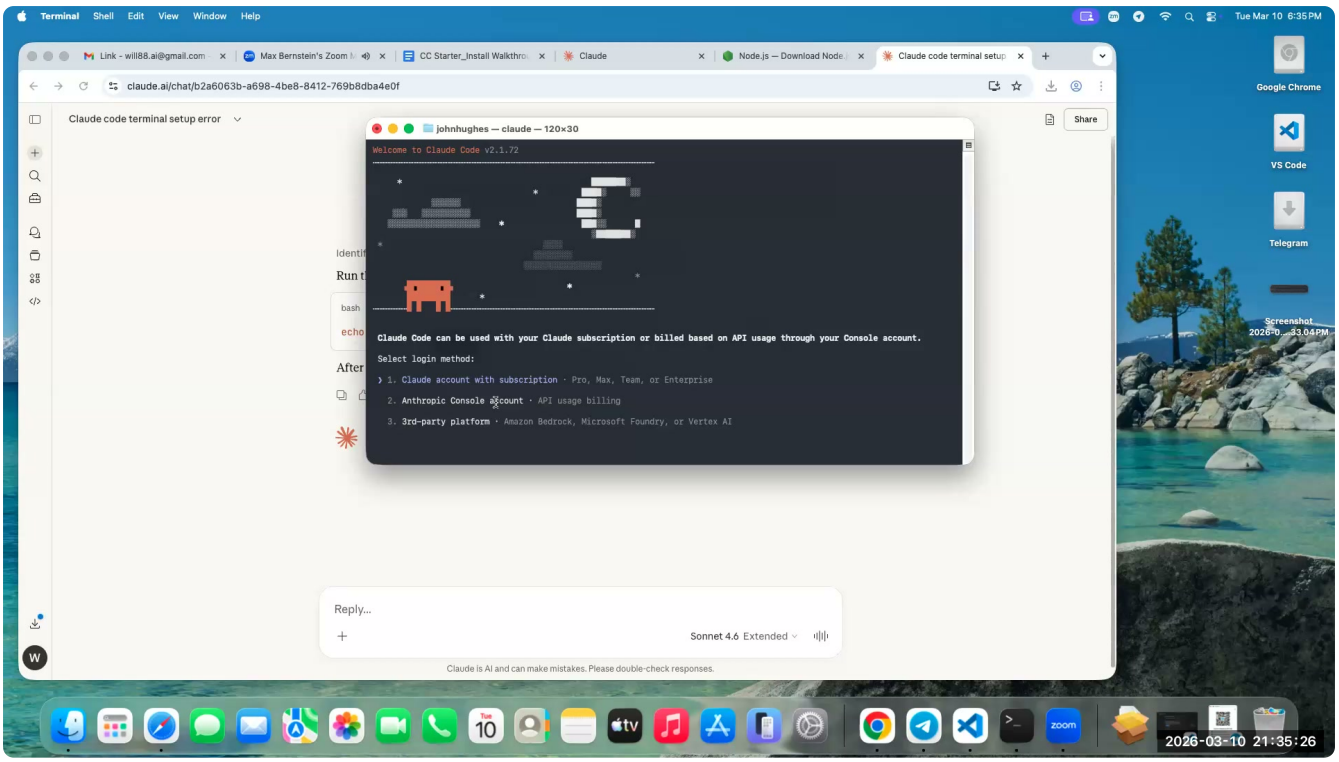
If you see a version number, skip to Step 3. If "command not found" or "not in your path":

```
echo 'export PATH="$HOME/.npm-global/bin:$PATH"' >> ~/.zshrc && source ~/.zshrc
```

Step 3: Log in

```
claude login
```

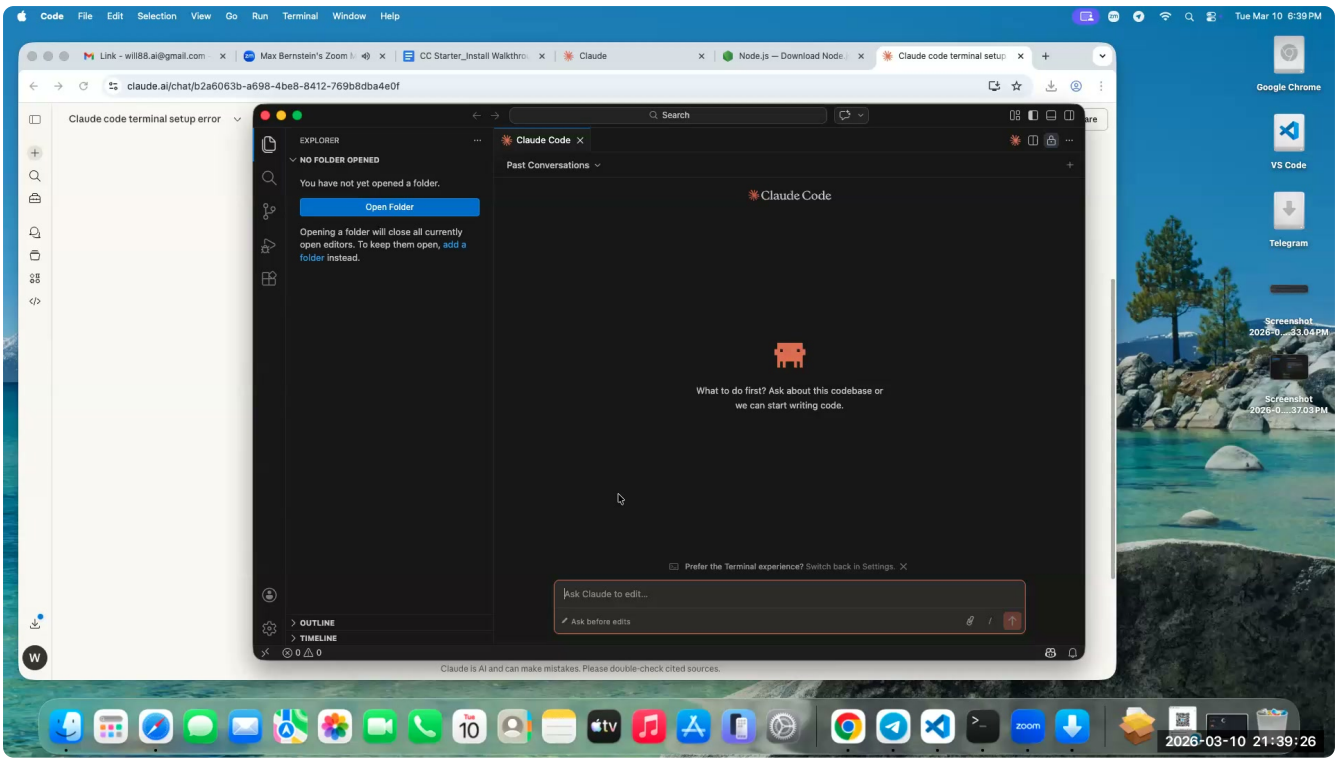
A browser window opens. Sign in with your Anthropic account.



Claude Code first launch -- select 'Claude account with subscription' (option 1)

Step 4: VS Code Extension (recommended)

- Open VS Code
- Press Command+Shift+X (opens Extensions panel)
- Search for "Claude Code"
- Click Install



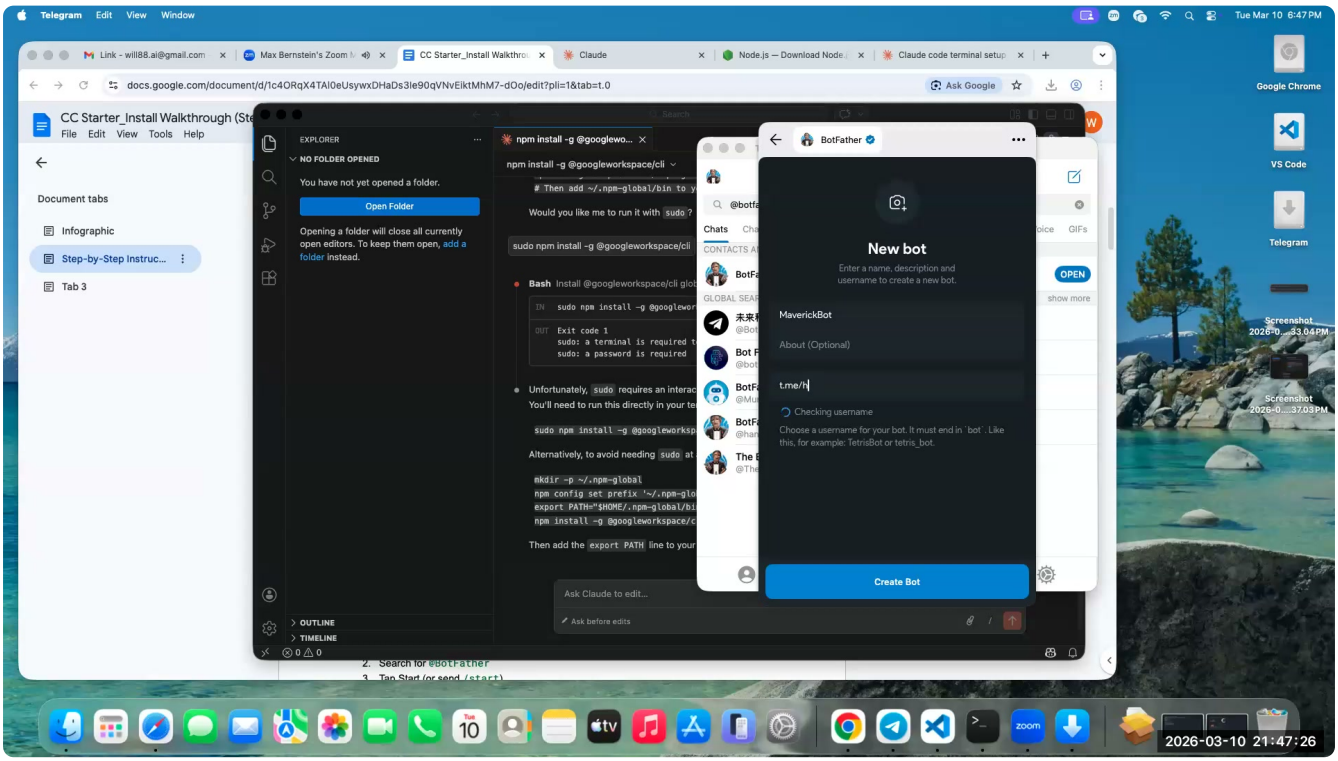
Claude Code running inside VS Code -- the panel on the right is where you'll interact

PHASE 3

Create Your Telegram Bot

3 minutes -- do this on your phone

- Open Telegram, search for @BotFather (blue checkmark)
- Tap Start, then send: /newbot
- It asks for a display name -- type whatever you want (e.g., "Maverick AI")
- It asks for a username -- must end in "bot" (e.g., maverick_ai_bot)
- BotFather gives you a token -- a long string like 7123456789:AAF...
- Copy that token and save it somewhere. You'll paste it in 5 minutes.



Creating a new bot in BotFather -- copy the token it gives you

PHASE 4

Clone and Configure

10 minutes

Step 1: Download the code

```
cd ~/Desktop
git clone https://github.com/moazbuilds/claudeclaw.git
cd claudeclaw
npm install
```

The npm install step takes 1-2 minutes. Wait for it to finish.

Step 2: Run the Setup Wizard

Run this in Terminal, not VS Code

The wizard needs keyboard input that doesn't work well inside Claude Code's panel. Use your regular Terminal window.

```
npm run setup
```

The wizard walks you through everything:

Screen 1-2: Welcome + System Checks

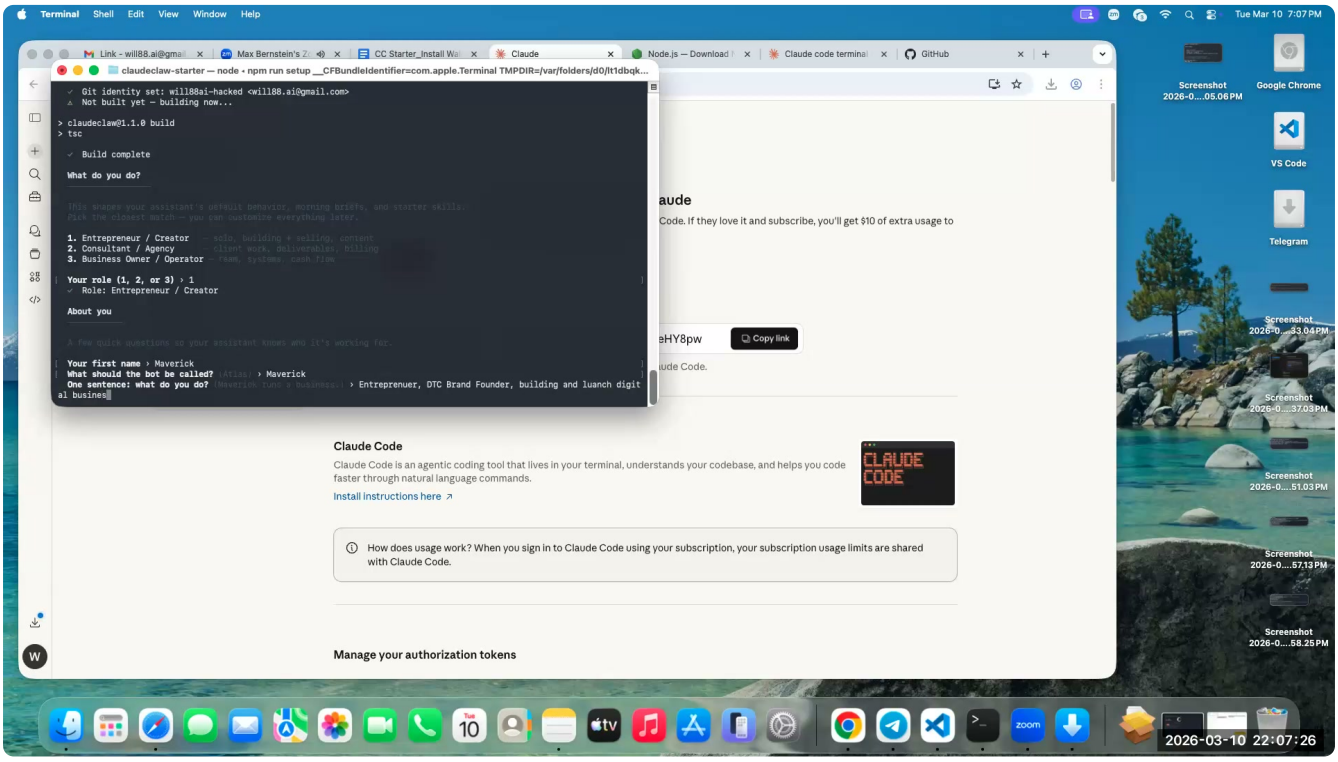
Press y to continue. Everything should show green checkmarks.

Screen 3: What do you do?

- 1 - Entrepreneur / Creator
- 2 - Consultant / Agency
- 3 - Business Owner / Operator

Screen 4: About You

- Your first name
- Bot name (e.g., "Maverick", "Atlas", "Friday")
- One sentence: what you do
- Obsidian vault path: press Enter to skip



The setup wizard: role selection and 'About you' fields

Screen 5: Autonomy Tiers

This is the important one. Three permission levels:

Green (just do it): Look things up, check calendar, create tasks, draft content, read emails

Yellow (confirm first): Send emails, post content, schedule meetings

Red (never): Delete data, make purchases, publish anything publicly

Press Enter on each to accept the sensible defaults. Edit later in CLAUDE.md.

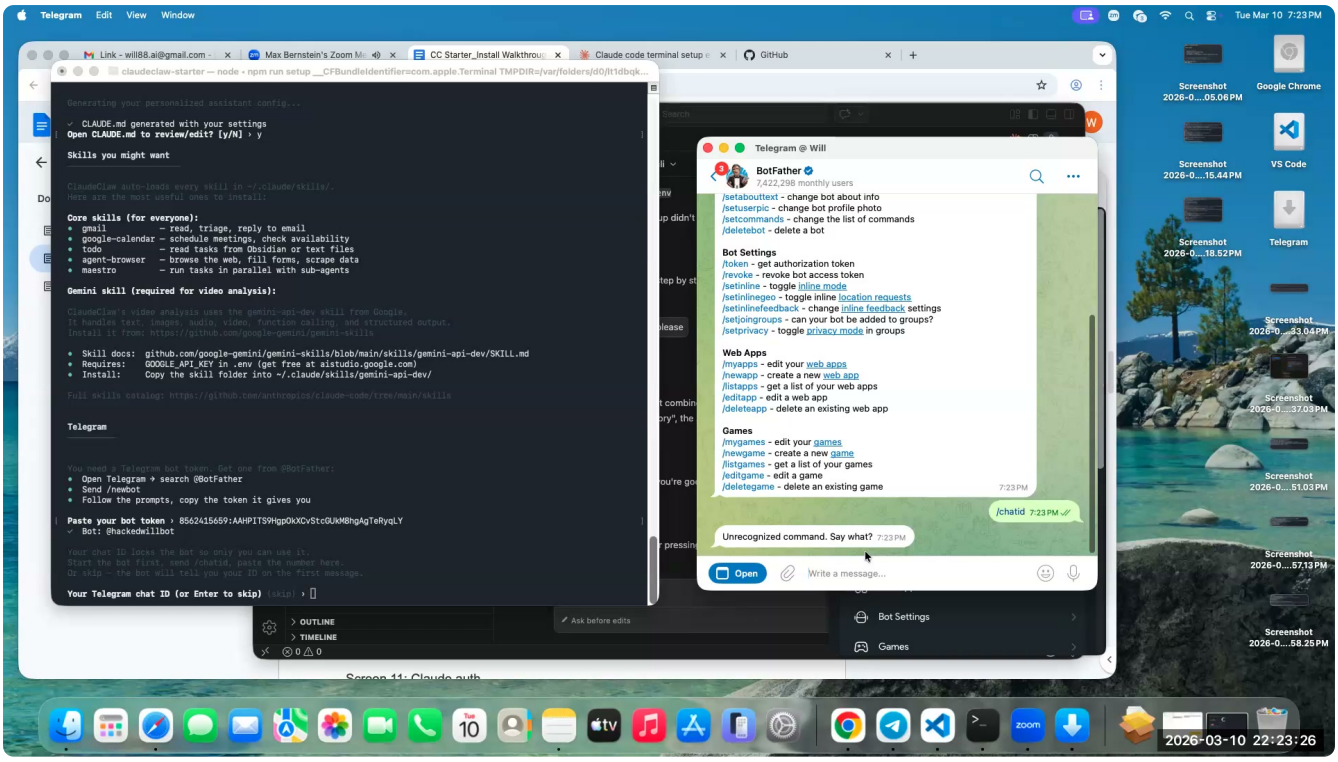
Screens 6-8: Features + CLAUDE.md

- Voice input (Groq Whisper)? y (free)
- Voice output (ElevenLabs)? y (set up later)
- Video analysis (Gemini)? y
- WhatsApp bridge? n (skip for now)
- Ecosystem repos? y to all three
- CLAUDE.md review? Press Enter to accept

Screen 9: Telegram

Paste the bot token you saved from BotFather.

Chat ID: Press Enter to skip. The bot tells you on first message.



Pasting the Telegram bot token during setup

Screens 10-13: Voice, Auth, Auto-start

- Voice: paste Groq API key if you have it, or Enter to skip
- Claude auth: press Enter (uses your subscription login)
- Auto-start: y (bot starts when Mac boots)

PHASE 5

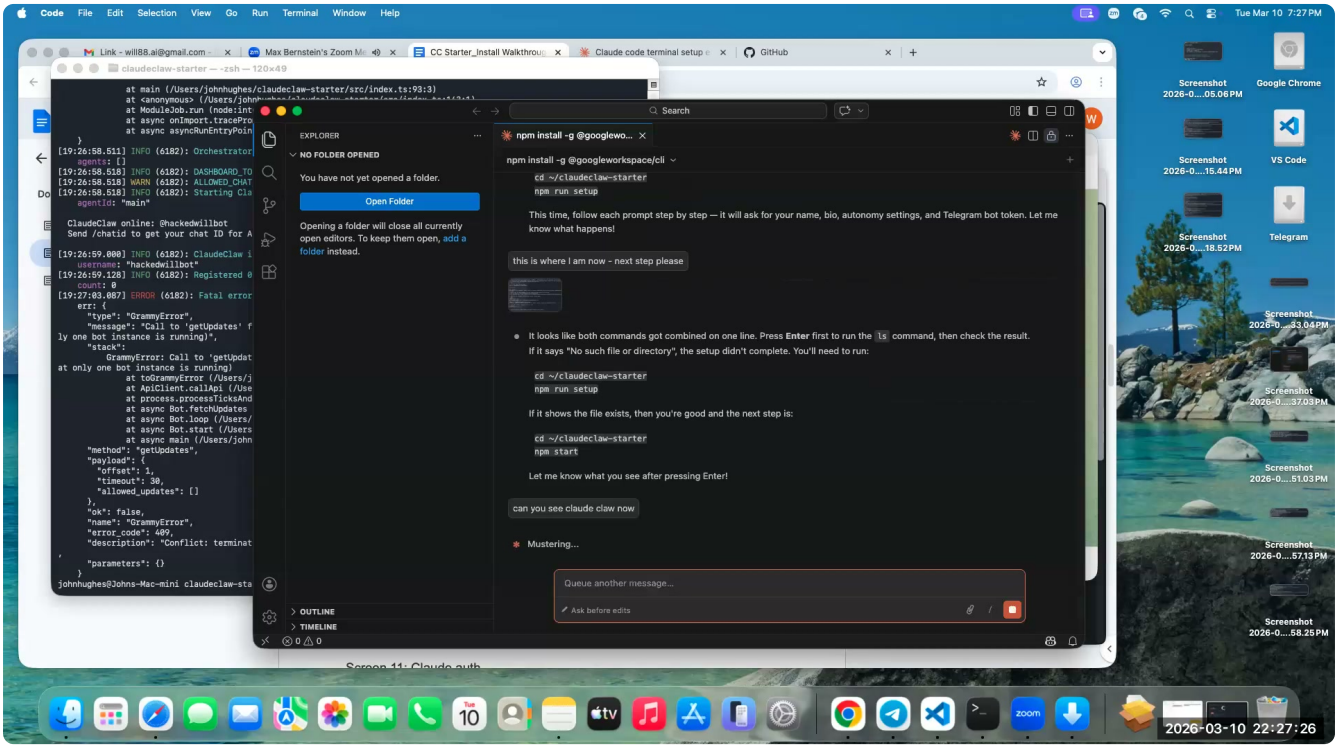
Start Your Bot

2 minutes

```
npm start
```

You should see the ClaudeClaw banner and "Bot online: @yourbotname".

If it says "not built": npm run build && npm start



ClaudeClaw online! The terminal shows 'Bot online' and the sidekick confirms next steps.

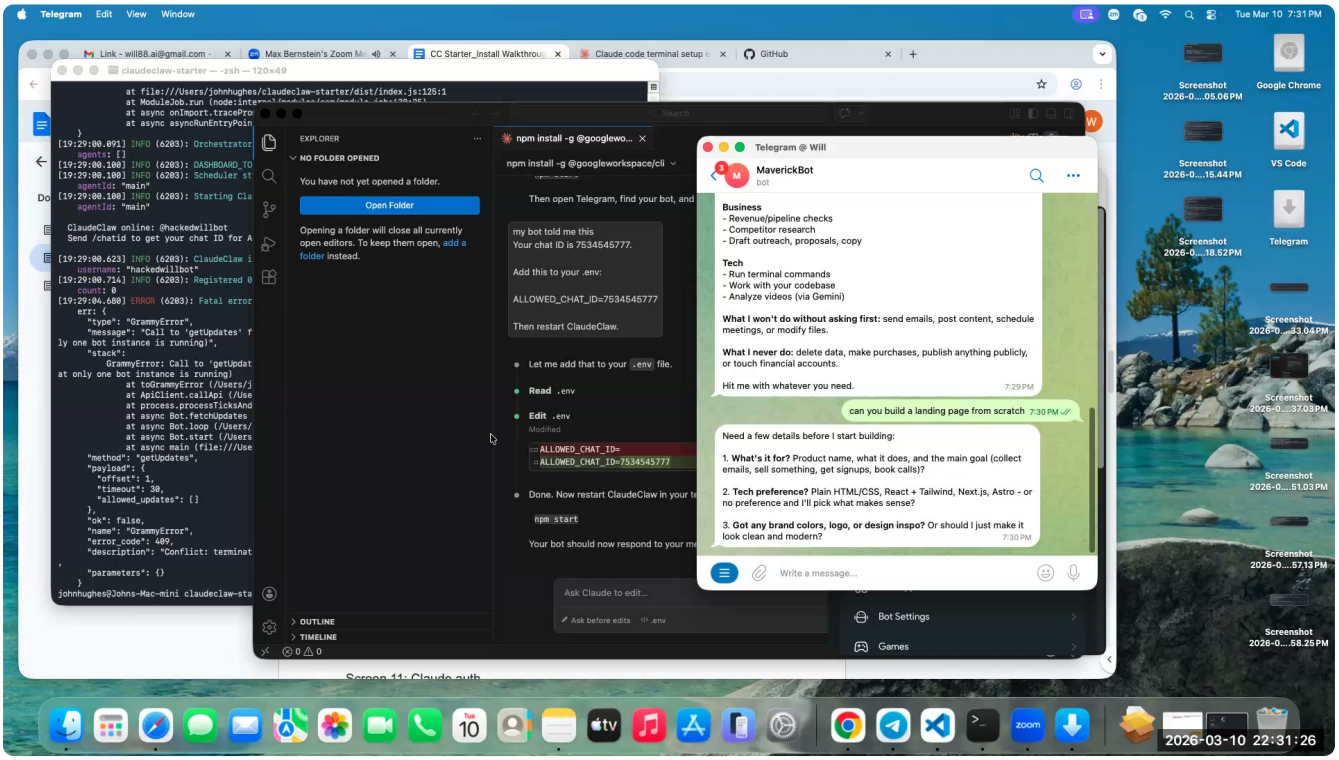
Send your first message

- Open Telegram on your phone
- Search for your bot's username
- Tap Start
- Send: hi

If the bot responds with a chat ID notice, copy that number, then update your .env file:

```
# Stop the bot: Control+C
nano .env
```

```
# Find ALLOWED_CHAT_ID= and paste your chat ID
# Save: Control+X, then Y, then Enter
npm start
```



MaverickBot's first response -- it introduces itself with its capabilities and permission levels

PHASE 6

Train Your Bot

5 minutes

This is the part that matters. The bot learns from corrections and remembers them forever.

Test the learning loop

Send any correction to your bot in Telegram:

- "From now on, always call me by my first name"
- "Never use exclamation points in anything you write"
- "Stop being so formal"
- "When I say morning, include my top 3 priorities"

The bot acknowledges it, edits its own CLAUDE.md file, and tells you what changed. That correction persists across every future conversation.

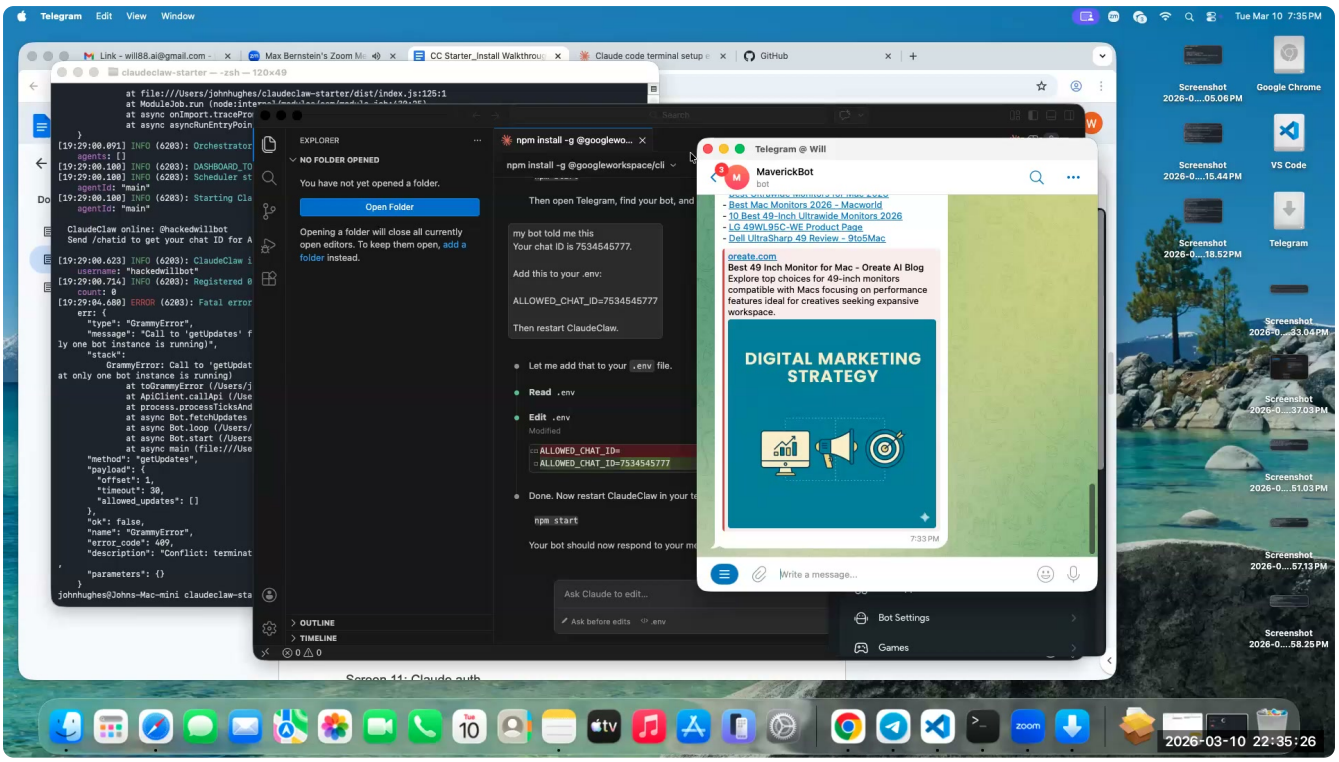
Try a few commands

- "What can you do?" -- see what's available
- "Morning" -- daily brief (needs Google connected)
- "Capture: [any idea]" -- saves to daily notes
- "Research [any topic]" -- multi-source web research

Set up a scheduled task

Send: "Send me a morning brief every day at 8am"

The bot creates a cron job. Tomorrow at 8am, you'll get an automatic briefing.



The bot doing web research -- asked for monitor recommendations and returned real results

PHASE 7

Connect Google (optional)

3 minutes

This lets your bot read your email and calendar. In a new Terminal window:

```
npm install -g @googleworkspace/cli
gws auth setup
```

Follow the prompts. A browser opens for Google sign-in. Approve permissions.

> **Tip**
>
> If you want the bot to see your main calendar without giving it your main Gmail, create a shared calendar and share it with the new Gmail account.

PHASE 8

Mac Mini Housekeeping

2 minutes

Prevent sleep

System Settings > Energy > turn OFF "Put hard disks to sleep". Set display sleep but NOT system sleep. The launchd service auto-restarts the bot if it crashes.

Quick reference

Task	Command
Start the bot	`npm start`
Stop the bot	`Control+C in Terminal`
Check if running	`npm run status`
See logs	`tail -f /tmp/claudeclaw.log`

Edit bot brain	`Open CLAUDE.md in any editor`
Add a skill	`Drop folder with SKILL.md into skills/`
Rebuild after changes	`npm run build && npm start`
Update from GitHub	`git pull && npm install && npm run build`

Troubleshooting

"command not found: node"

Close Terminal completely (Command+Q), reopen it. Node needs a fresh shell after install.

"command not found: claude"

Run npm install -g @anthropic-ai/claude-code again. Permission errors? Add sudo in front.

"command not found: brew"

You didn't run the PATH commands after Homebrew install. Go back to Phase 1, Step 1.

"not in your path"

Run: echo 'export PATH="$HOME/.npm-global/bin:$PATH"' >> ~/.zshrc && source ~/.zshrc

Permission errors (EACCES)

Add sudo before the command and enter your Mac password.

Bot doesn't respond

Check Terminal for errors. Make sure ALLOWED_CHAT_ID is set in .env. Make sure bot is running.

Stuck in vim

Type :q! and press Enter. Then :q! and Enter again if needed.

Garbled text in Terminal

Press Control+C, then type reset and press Enter.

What's Next

Skills included in your starter kit

- gmail -- read, triage, reply to email
- google-calendar -- view schedule, create events
- morning-brief -- daily briefing with calendar + email + priorities
- quick-capture -- save ideas to daily notes files
- web-research -- multi-source research with confidence levels
- tldr -- summarize conversations and save notes

The learning loop

Every correction you make gets written into CLAUDE.md and persists forever. The more you correct, the more personalized it becomes. After a week of corrections, your bot behaves nothing like a default Claude session.